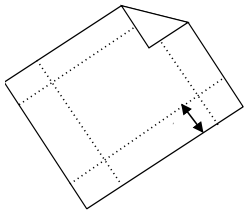
1.35 Differentiation: Optimisation

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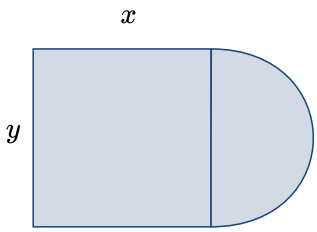
Optimisation Problems/Modelling

70



We have a sheet of A4 paper, which we want to fold into a cuboid. What height should we choose for the cuboid in order to maximise the volume?

These are examples of **optimisation problems**: we're trying to maximise/minimise some quantity by choosing an appropriate value of a variable that we can control.



We have 50m of fencing, and want to make a bear pen of the following shape, such that the area is maximised. What should we choose x and y to be?

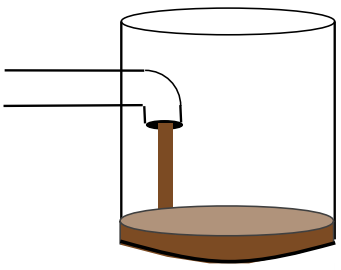
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'Rate of change'

71

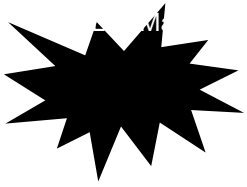
Up to now we've had y in terms of x, where $\frac{dy}{dx}$ means "the **rate** at which y changes with respect to x".

But we can use similar gradient function notation for other **physical quantities**.



A sewage container fills at a rate of 20 cm^3 per second.

How could we use appropriate notation to represent this?



1.35 Differentiation: Optimisation

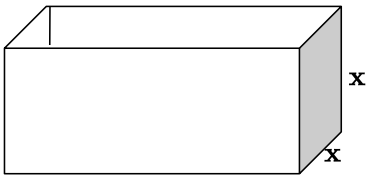
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Example Optimisation Problem

72

Optimisation problems in an exam usually follow the following pattern:

- There are 2 variables involved (you may have to introduce one yourself), typically lengths.
- There are expressions for **two different physical quantities**:
  - One is a **constraint**, e.g. "the surface area is 20cm^2".
  - The **other we wish to maximise/minimise**, e.g. "we wish to maximise the volume".
- We use the constraint to **eliminate one of the variables** in the latter equation, so that it is then **just in terms of one variable**, and we can then use differentiation to find the turning point.



[Textbook] A large tank in the shape of a cuboid is to be made from 54m^2 of sheet metal. The tank has a horizontal base and no top. The height of the tank is x metres. Two of the opposite vertical faces are squares.

a) Show that the volume, V m^3, of the tank is given by $V = 18x - \frac{2}{3}x^3$.

b) Given that x can vary, use differentiation to find the maximum or minimum value of V.

$\frac{dV}{dt}$

$V =$

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Test Your Understanding

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Edexcel C2 May 2011 Q8

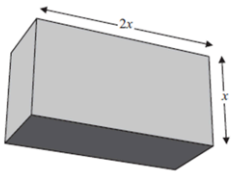


Figure 2

A cuboid has a rectangular cross-section where the length of the rectangle is equal to twice its width, x cm, as shown in Figure 2.

The volume of the cuboid is 81 cubic centimetres.

(a) Show that the total length, L cm, of the twelve edges of the cuboid is given by $L = 12x + \frac{162}{x^2}$.

\hfill (3)

(b) Use calculus to find the minimum value of L. \hfill (6)

(c) Justify, by further differentiation, that the value of L that you have found is a minimum. \hfill (2)

(b) $\frac{dL}{dx}$

Either 1

Correct $\{\frac{dL}{dx} =$

$L' = 0$

$x = \sqrt[3]{2}$

$\{x = 3$

Substitu

$54 \qua$

(c) {For

Correct f

$\frac{972}{x^3}$ an

(a)

$\{V =\}$

$\{L = 2($

$y = \frac{81}{2x^2}$

Making y

So, $L =$

Correct s

1.35 Differentiation: Optimisation

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Exercise 12K – Pearson Pure Y1 page 81

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6 A rectangular garden is fenced on three sides, and the house forms the fourth side of the rectangle.

a Given that the total length of the fence is $80\,\text{m}$, show that the area, A, of the garden is given by the formula $A = y(80 - 2y)$, where y is the distance from the house to the end of the garden.

b Given that the area is a maximum for this length of fence, find the dimensions of the enclosed garden, and the area which is enclosed.

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Exercise 12K – Pearson Pure Y1 page 81

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7 A closed cylinder has total surface area equal to 600π.
a Show that the volume, $V\,\text{cm}^3$, of this cylinder is given by the formula $V = 300\pi r - \pi r^3$, where $r\,\text{cm}$ is the radius of the cylinder.
b Find the maximum volume of such a cylinder.

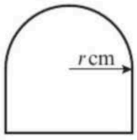
1.35 Differentiation: Optimisation

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Exercise 12K – Pearson Pure Y1 page 81

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9 A shape consists of a rectangular base with a semicircular top, as shown.



a Given that the perimeter of the shape is $40\,\text{cm}$, show that its area, $A\,\text{cm}^2$, is given by the formula

$A = 40r - 2r^2 - \frac{\pi r^2}{2}$

where r cm is the radius of the semicircle. \hfill (2 marks)

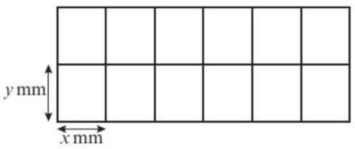
b Hence find the maximum value for the area of the shape. \hfill (4 marks)

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Exercise 12K – Pearson Pure Y1 page 81

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10 The shape shown is a wire frame in the form of a large rectangle split by parallel lengths of wire into 12 smaller equal-sized rectangles.



a Given that the total length of wire used to complete the whole frame is $1512\,\text{mm}$, show that the area of the whole shape, $A\,\text{mm}^2$, is given by the formula

$A = 1296x - \frac{108x^2}{7}$

where x mm is the width of one of the smaller rectangles. \hfill (4 marks)

b Hence find the maximum area which can be enclosed in this way. \hfill (4 marks)